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Scott Nelson

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Academic Positions

University of Illinois; Urbana, IL — 2025–present
Assistant Professor – Department of Linguistics

University of Illinois; Urbana, IL — 2024–2025
Instructor – Department of Linguistics

Education

Stony Brook University; Stony Brook, NY — 2024
Ph.D. Linguistics
Dissertation: *The Computational Structure of Phonological and Phonetic Knowledge*

Michigan State University; East Lansing, MI — 2019
M.A. Linguistics
Thesis: *The Generalizable Nature of Lexical Retuning*

Michigan State University; East Lansing, MI — 2017
B.A. Linguistics (High Honors)
Thesis: *Perceptual Retuning Targets Features*

Additional

University of Massachusetts Amherst; Amherst, MA — 2023
Linguistic Society of America Summer Institute

Institute for Advanced Computational Science; Stony Brook, NY — 2022
Advanced Graduate Certificate in Data and Computational Science

Publications

Refereed Journal Articles

3. **Nelson, S.** & Heinz, J. (2025). "The Blueprint Model of Production". *Phonology* 42. DOI: 10.1017/S0952675725100055
2. Taherkhani, N. & **Nelson, S.** (2024). "Southern Tati: Takestani Dialect". *Journal of the International Phonetic Association* 54(1):559-574. DOI: 10.1017/S0025100323000270
1. **Nelson, S.** & Durvasula, K. (2021). "Lexically-Guided Perceptual Learning does Generalize to New Contexts". *Journal of Phonetics* 86. DOI: 10.1016/j.wocn.2020.101019.

Paper-Reviewed Conference Proceedings

1. **Nelson, S.** (2022). "A Model Theoretic Perspective on Phonological Feature Systems". *Proceedings of the Society for Computation in Linguistics* 5(1), 1-10.

Abstract-Reviewed Conference Proceedings

6. **Nelson, S.** & Baković, E. (2026). "A BMRS analysis of Trojan (and transparent) vowels in Hungarian vowel harmony". *Proceedings of the 2026 Linguistics Society of America Annual Meeting*.
5. **Nelson, S.** (2025). "Optionality and the Phonetics-Phonology Interface". *Proceedings of the 42nd West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics*.
4. **Nelson, S.** & Baković, E. (2024). "Underspecification without Underspecified Representations". *Proceedings of the Society for Computation in Linguistics* 7(1).
3. **Nelson, S.** & Heinz, J. (2022). "Incomplete Neutralization and the Blueprint Model of Production". In Peter Jurgec, Liisa Duncan, Emily Elfner, Yoonjung Kang, Alexei Kochetov, Brittney K. O'Neill, Avery Ozburn, Karen Rice, Nathan Sanders, Jessamyn Schertz, Nate Shaftoe, and Lisa Sullivan (eds.), *Proceedings of the 2021 Annual Meeting on Phonology*. Washington DC: Linguistics Society of America.
2. Pue, A.S. & **Nelson, S.** (2018). "Marking Poetic Time: Building and Annotating a Hindi-Urdu Poetry Corpus for Computational Humanities Research". *Proceedings of the Second Workshop on Corpus-based Research in the Humanities (CRH-2)*, 171-180.
1. Durvasula, K. & **Nelson, S.** (2017). "Lexical Retuning Targets Features". In Gallagher, Gillian, Gouskova, Maria, and Sora Yin (eds.), *Proceedings of the 2017 Annual Meeting on Phonology*. Washington DC: Linguistics Society of America.

Manuscripts Submitted/Under Review

5. Corrigan, R. & **Nelson, S.** "Endpoint Performance and Incremental Dynamics in Models of Vowel Perception" (under review).
4. **Nelson, S.** "On inferring linear order from non-linear gestural representations" (under review).
3. **Nelson, S.**, Dolatian, H. and Heinz, J. "Horizons" (chapter to appear in *Doing Computational Phonology*; Oxford University Press)
2. Stephanov, A. and **Nelson, S.** "Methodological Triangulation in Phonological Theory: Formalizing the Venetian 'Evanescent' /l/" (under review)
1. **Nelson, S.** and Baković, E. "Feature spreading, redundancy, and blocking" (under review).

Manuscripts in Preparation

5. Hayes, M. and **Nelson, S.** "Computing rhyme: a tier-based strictly local approach to poetic rhyme as harmony." (revising)
4. **Nelson, S.** and King, M. "Computing Tier-Based Functions using Boolean Monadic Recursive Schemes." (revising)
3. Taherkhani, N., **Nelson, S.** & Heinz, J. "Vowel alternations as evidence for contrastive vowel features in Southern Tati: Takestani dialect" (revising).
2. **Nelson, S.** "The logic and typology of derived environment effects" (in preparation).
1. **Nelson, S.** and Baković, E. "Underspecification: representation and computation." (in preparation).

Presentations

Invited Talks

1. **Nelson, S.** (2026). Algorithms + Data Structures = Speech Production Programs. Mayfest. University of Maryland. College Park, MD, USA.

Talks

27. **Nelson, S.** (2026). Variable Phenomena and Logical Transductions. The 2026 Rutgers Subregular Morphophonology Workshop. Rutguers University. New Brunswick, NJ, USA.
26. **Nelson, S.** and King, M. (2026). Search and Copy/Change with Boolean Monadic Recursive Schemes. Annual Meeting on Phonology 2026. University of Maryland. College Park, MD, USA.

25. **Nelson, S.** (2026). Formalizing phonological knowledge verses usage with weighted logic. Cambridge University, Cambridge, UK, England.

24. **Nelson, S.** (2026). Discrete Interpretations of Continuous Representations in Model-Theoretic Computational Phonology. Workshop on The Role of Representation in Computational Phonology. Cambridge University, Cambridge, UK, England.

23. **Nelson, S.** (2026). Phonological Knowlege, Weighted Logic, and the Competence/Performance Distinction. Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America. New Orleans, LA, USA.

22. **Nelson, S.** & Baković, E. (2026). A BMRS analysis of Trojan vowels in Hungarian vowel harmony. Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America. New Orleans, LA, USA.

21. Stephanov, A. & **Nelson, S.** (2025). Formalizing the Venetian 'Evanescent' /l/: A Three-Perspective Analysis. Going Romance 2025. Ca' Foscari University of Venice, Venice, Italy.

20. Stephanov, A. & **Nelson, S.** (2025). Formalizing the Venetian 'Evanescent' /l/: A Three-Perspective Analysis. Annual Meeting on Phonology 2025. University of California Berkeley, Berkeley, CA, USA.

19. **Nelson, S.** (2025). Using Model Theory and Function Types to Formally Relate Symbolic and Dynamic Theories of Speech. Dynamic Models of Speech. University of Oregon, Eugene, Oregon, USA.

18. **Nelson, S.** (2025). Phonological Knowledge, Weighted Logic, and the Competence/Performance Distinction. North American Phonology Conference 13. Concordia University, Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

17. **Nelson, S.** (2024). [Coronal] is Never Underspecified in English: a Computational View. 29th Annual Mid-Continental Phonetics & Phonology Conference. University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign. Urbana, Illinois, USA.

16. **Nelson, S.** (2024). BMRS and Underspecification. Rutgers Subregular Phonology Workshop. Rutgers University. New Brunswick, NJ, USA.

15. **Nelson, S.** (2024). Optionality and the Phonetics-Phonology Interface. 42nd West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics. University of California Berkeley, Berkeley, California, USA.

14. Chandlee, J., Jardine, A., & **Nelson, S.** (2024) Tutorial: Logic and Model Theory for Phonology. Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America. New York, New York, USA.

13. **Nelson, S.** (2023). Model Theoretic Phonology and Theory Comparison: Segments, Gestures, and Coupling Graphs. North American Phonology Conference 12. Concordia University, Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

12. Taherkhani, N., **Nelson, S.**, & Heinz, J. (2023). A Contrastive Hierarchy for Vowels in Southern Tati: Takestani Dialect. North American Conference in Iranian Linguistics 3. University of California Los Angeles, Los Angeles, California, USA.

11. **Nelson, S.** (2022). Gestures, Coupling Graphs, and Strings. Workshop on Model Theoretic Representations in Phonology. Stony Brook University. Stony Brook, New York, USA.

10. Heinz, J. & **Nelson, S.** (2022). The Past, Present, and Future of Model Theoretic Phonology. Workshop on Model Theoretic Representations in Phonology. Stony Brook University. Stony Brook, New York, USA.
9. **Nelson, S.** (2022). A Model Theoretic Perspective on Phonological Feature Systems. Society for Computation in Linguistics 2022.
8. **Nelson, S.** (2022). The Blueprint Model of Production. IACS Student Seminar. Institute for Advanced Computational Science. Stony Brook, New York, USA.
7. **Nelson, S.** & Heinz, J. (2021). Incomplete Neutralization and the Blueprint Model of Production. Annual Meeting on Phonology 2021. University of Toronto. Toronto, Ontario, Canada.
6. **Nelson, S.** (2021). What can logic and model theory tell us about phonological feature systems? Phonology in the Northeast 2021. New York University, New York, New York, USA.
5. **Nelson, S.** (2020). The logical language of phonological features. Northeastern Computational Phonology Workshop 2020. Maryland University. College Park, Maryland, USA.
4. **Nelson, S.** & Heinz, J. (2020). Incomplete Neutralization is no Problem for Formal Phonology. Workshop on Theoretical Phonology 2020. Concordia University. Montreal, Quebec, Canada.
3. **Nelson, S.** (2018). Lexical retuning is not the same as audio-visual retuning: the former generalizes better. 23rd Annual Mid-Continental Phonetics & Phonology Conference. Northwestern University. Evanston, Illinois, USA.
2. Pue, A. Sean & **Nelson, S.** (2018). Marking Poetic Time: Building and Annotating a Hindi-Urdu Poetry Corpus for Computational Humanities Research. Corpus-based Research in the Humanities 2, Austrian Academy of Science. Vienna, Austria.
1. Durvasula, K. & **Nelson, S.** (2017). Perceptual retuning targets features. Annual Meeting on Phonology 2017. New York University. New York, New York, USA.

POSTERS

10. **Nelson, S.**, Yeung, D., & King, M. (2026). Computing Long-Distance Phenomena with Boolean Monadic Recursive Schemes. 31st Annual Mid-Continental Phonetics & Phonology Conference. St. Louis University. St. Louis, MO, USA.
9. **Nelson, S.** & Baković, E. (2026). Feature spreading and redundancy with BMRS. Old-World Conference in Phonology 23. Cambridge University, Cambridge, UK, England.
8. Hayes, M. & **Nelson, S.** (2026). Poetic Rhyme as a Tier-Based Strictly Local Constraint. Annual Meeting of the Lingusitic Society of America. New Orleans, LA, USA.
7. **Nelson, S.** & Baković, E. (2024). Computation Clarifies Mixed Specification Behavior of Coronals in English. Annual Meeting on Phonology 2024. Rutgers University. New Brunswick, New Jersey, USA.

6. **Nelson, S.** & Baković, E. (2024). Underspecification without Underspecified Representations. Society for Computation in Linguistics 2022. University of California Irvine. Irvine, California, USA.
5. **Nelson, S.** (2023). Unordered rules that only apply to the input are not more complex than ordered rules. M100. Massachusetts Institute of Technology. Cambridge, Massachusetts, USA.
4. **Nelson, S.** (2022). Are Representations in Articulatory and Generative Phonology so different? Annual Meeting on Phonology 2022. University of California Los Angeles. Los Angeles, California, USA.
3. **Nelson, S.** (2022). Testing the Equality of Phonological Structures Using Declarative Programs. IACS 5 Year Review. Institute for Advanced Computational Science. Stony Brook, New York, USA.
2. **Nelson, S.** (2019) Generalization in the absence of variation within lexical retuning. Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America. New York, New York, USA.
1. Durvasula, K. & **Nelson, S.** (2018). Retuning generalizes to new contexts. 16th Conference on Laboratory Phonology. University of Lisboa. Lisboa, Portugal.

Teaching

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

LING 304: Elements of Morphology (S25)
LING 401: Intro to General Phonetics (F24; F26)
LING 490: Special Topics in Ling [Computation & Phonological Theory] (S25; F26)
LING 490: Special Topics in Ling [Learnability & Linguistic Theory] (S26)
LING 502: Phonology 1 (S25; F25; S27)
LING 542: Phonology 2 (F24)
LING 588: Applied Multivariate Data Analysis (S26)

Stony Brook University

LIN 200: Language in the United States (W22)
LIN 350: Experimental Phonetics (SU23)
LIN 405: Writing in Linguistics (SU21)
LIN 522: Phonetics (SU20; SU22)

Invited Lectures

2. The Blueprint Model of Production. LIGN 115: Phonology II. University of California San Diego. (Spring 2023)
1. Introduction to TaDA. LIN 828: Phonetics 2. Michigan State University. (Fall 2022)

5. Data + Computation = Discovery! Research Methods and Professional Development Seminar. Institute for Advance Computational Science. Stony Brook, New York, USA. (2024)
4. New York Institute Introduction to Mathematical Linguistics. Online. (2024)
3. Department of Linguistics Statistics Minicourse. Stony Brook University. Stony Brook, New York, USA. (2023)
2. Linguistics Minicourse. The Stony Brook School. Stony Brook, New York, USA. (2022)
1. Summer Youth Camp in Computational Linguistics. Stony Brook University. Stony Brook, New York, USA. (2020-2024)

Advising

*Note, all students mentioned were advised as part of the linguistics program at UIUC unless otherwise stated.

Chair PhD Committee

2. Mikhael Hayes [PhD expected, Spring 2028]
1. Ryan Corrigan [PhD expected, Spring 2027]

Member of PhD Committee

2. Maialen Casquete De La Puente [PhD expected, Spring 2027]
1. Hyunjung Joo [Rutgers University, 2026]
   The Representation and Computation of Intonation

Qualifying Paper Adviser

2. Daniel Yueng [expected, 2027]
1. Mikhael Hayes [2026]
   Computing Rhyme

Qualifying Paper Reader

2. Tai Armstrong [2026]
   Targeted Syntactic Evaluation of Russian LLMs With a Focus on Noun-Adjective Concord
1. Anna Stephanov [2026]
   Lateral Lenition and Phonologization: The 'Evanescent' /l/ in Estense Veneto

BA Thesis Adviser

1. Angie Lee [2026]
   A Computational Analysis of Malay affixation morphophonology

Reviewing

Journals

Canadian Journal of Linguistics; Journal of Logic, Language, and Information; Natural Language and Linguistic Theory

Books

Cambridge University Press

Conference Abstracts

Annual Meeting on Phonology; Formal Approaches to South Asian Linguistics; North East Linguistics Society; OCP Satellite Workshop on the Role of Representation in Computational Phonology

Conference Papers

Society for Computation in Linguistics

Awards, Honors, and Fellowships

Funded Awards and Fellowships

2. Institute for Advance Computational Science Junior Researcher Award 2022-2023 ($34,000)

1. Institute for Advance Computational Science Junior Researcher Award 2021-2022 ($34,000)

Teaching Awards

1. Stony Brook University President's Award for Excellence in Teaching by a Graduate Student 2023 ($1,000)

Events Organized

2. Special Session on Formal Language Theory in Morphology and Phonology at the Linguistic Society of America 2024 Annual Meeting (with Jeffrey Heinz, and Jon Rawski). New York, New York. January 2024.
1. Workshop on Model Theoretic Representations in Phonology (with Jeffrey Heinz). Stony Brook University. Stony Brook, New York. September 2022.

Service

Stony Brook University

Organizer, Phonology Reading Group (2021-2022)
Organizer, Linguistics Colloquium Series (2020-2021)
Organizer, Mathematical Linguistics Reading Group (2020)

Michigan State University

Organizer, Linguistics Colloquium Series (2017-2018)

Natural Language Proficiency

Native: English
Beginner: American Sign Language, Swedish, Spanish
Fieldwork: Southern Tati

Computing

Advanced: Praat, LaTeX, R
Intermediate: Python, Markdown, Git, Haskell
Beginner: PsychoPy, Matlab, Prolog